

DELHI | Knick of Time

In a decision that will irrevocably alter political fashion, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) is contemplating changing one half of its trademark uniform. No, not the crisp white shirt, but the RSS standout, knobbly knee-and-hirsute-leg-revealing, flared khaki shorts. The idea was born at a Nainital meeting, some say. Seventy or so meetings are expected to be held on the subject to take the view of functionaries and cadres. The sartorial soul-searching was born when it was noticed that the attendance in shakhas was falling, a very specific worry for Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat. At a recent meeting in Mangalore of sharirik pramukhs (physical instructors), General Secretary Bhaiyaji Joshi said, "We have to change everything that is outdated" to attract new (and trendy) youth to the RSS. So naturally, the knickers had to go. Track suits are being suggested as an alternative. A final decision is expected at the March Pratinidhi Sabha meeting in Kurukshetra.

by Shyamal Yadav



BHAWAN SINGH

THE RSS UNIFORM IS SET TO CHANGE

After Math

Commerce Minister Anand Sharma is battling the shadow of his flamboyant predecessor Kamal Nath. Industry and business confess they still reflexively mark correspondence to "Union Minister for Commerce Kamal Nath" before correcting themselves



MAHADEO SEN

RANA (CENTRE)

RANCHI | Jail Fodder

Former MP and RJD leader Rabindra Kumar Rana is the first politician to be convicted in the infamous Rs 950-crore fodder scam of the 1990s. A CBI court convicted Rana for illegally withdrawing Rs 28.26 lakh from the Godda district treasury by producing fake invoices. For his crime, and connivance with officials and fodder suppliers between January and June 1992, Rana has been sentenced to five years' rigorous imprisonment and fined Rs 4.9 lakh. Ten other politicians and nine senior bureaucrats figure in the list of fodder scam accused. These include big fish like Lalu Prasad Yadav and Jagannath Mishra. Rana is the 32nd accused to be convicted in the case.

by Amitabh Srivastava

DELHI | Bigger Screen

Premier news channel Aaj Tak has consolidated its leadership once again. According to the latest viewership data (TAM, 15+ All India, Week 30), Aaj Tak continues to be the preferred news channel with a market share of 20.6 per cent and a weekly reach of 5.26 crore. Aaj Tak is the only news channel to cross the 5-crore mark in terms of weekly viewership. Aroon Purie, chairman and managing director of TV Today, the parent group of Aaj Tak, said, "It is heartening to note that we have grown our top-line and bottom-line in spite of a



difficult environment. I am glad that as a TV network, TV Today continues to set the agenda in the news space. Each of our offerings is unique and that is why they have all made a distinct space for themselves. We will continue to deliver value to investors and advertisers by expanding our news base." Aaj Tak was launched in December 2000 and since then, TV Today has ensured that the small screen has only grown bigger.